

AI Engineer Academy – Website Launch Checklist

Before you deploy, every box must be checked.

1. Content & Copy

- [] All pages have real content (no lorem ipsum or placeholder text)
- [] Spelling and grammar checked on every page
- [] Contact information is correct (email, phone, address)
- [] All links work (no broken links – test every single one)
- [] Call-to-action (CTA) buttons on every page
- [] Privacy policy page added
- [] Terms of service page added (if applicable)
- [] 404 error page designed (not the default ugly one)

2. Images & Media

- [] All images are compressed (use TinyPNG or Squoosh – under 200KB each)
- [] Images use proper formats (WebP for photos, SVG for icons/logos)
- [] Every image has alt text (for accessibility and SEO)
- [] No stretched or pixelated images
- [] Favicon uploaded (the small icon in the browser tab)
- [] Open Graph image set (the image that shows when shared on social media)
- [] Logo is crisp and properly sized

3. SEO (Search Engine Optimization)

- [] Unique page title for every page (under 60 characters)
- [] Meta description for every page (under 160 characters)
- [] Open Graph tags set (og:title, og:description, og:image, og:url)
- [] Twitter card tags set (twitter:card, twitter:title, twitter:description, twitter:image)
- [] H1 heading on every page (only one H1 per page)
- [] Heading hierarchy is correct (H1 → H2 → H3, not random)
- [] URL slugs are clean and readable (/about not /page?id=123)

- [] Sitemap.xml generated and submitted
- [] Robots.txt file configured
- [] Canonical URLs set to avoid duplicate content

4. Performance & Speed

- [] Page loads in under 3 seconds (test with Google PageSpeed Insights)
- [] Images are lazy loaded (load only when user scrolls to them)
- [] CSS and JavaScript files are minified
- [] No unused CSS or JavaScript loaded
- [] Fonts are optimized (use font-display: swap)
- [] Google PageSpeed score above 80 for both mobile and desktop

5. Mobile & Responsive

- [] Website looks perfect on mobile phones
- [] Website looks perfect on tablets
- [] Website looks perfect on desktop
- [] Text is readable without zooming on mobile
- [] Buttons and links are easy to tap on mobile (min 44x44px)
- [] Navigation menu works on mobile (hamburger menu)
- [] No horizontal scrolling on any device
- [] Tested on at least 3 different screen sizes

6. Security

- [] SSL certificate active (HTTPS, not HTTP – the padlock icon)
- [] Environment variables used for API keys (never hardcoded)
- [] No sensitive data exposed in frontend code
- [] Form inputs are validated and sanitized
- [] Rate limiting on forms to prevent spam
- [] CORS configured properly if using APIs

7. Forms & Functionality

- [] All forms submit correctly (test every single form)

- [] Form validation works (required fields, email format, etc.)
- [] Success/error messages show after form submission
- [] Email notifications arrive when forms are submitted
- [] Forms are protected against spam (honeypot or reCAPTCHA)
- [] All buttons do what they're supposed to do

8. Analytics & Tracking

- [] Google Analytics 4 installed
- [] Google Search Console connected
- [] Event tracking on key CTAs (button clicks, form submissions)
- [] Cookie consent banner added (required in many regions)

9. Accessibility

- [] All images have alt text
- [] Color contrast is sufficient (text readable against backgrounds)
- [] Website is navigable with keyboard only
- [] Focus states visible on interactive elements
- [] ARIA labels on interactive elements where needed
- [] Font size is at least 16px for body text

10. Pre-Launch Final Checks

- [] Custom domain connected and working
- [] WWW and non-WWW both redirect to the same URL
- [] Website works on Chrome, Firefox, Safari, and Edge
- [] All social media links point to correct profiles
- [] Website loads correctly when shared on WhatsApp, LinkedIn, Twitter
- [] Google PageSpeed Insights run – screenshot your score
- [] Backup of all code pushed to GitHub

11. Post-Launch

- [] Submit sitemap to Google Search Console
- [] Share the live link in the AI Engineer Academy community

- [] Add the live URL to your Project Tracker spreadsheet
- [] Take a screenshot and add it to your portfolio
- [] Celebrate – you just shipped a real project

Your Score: _____ / 73 checks completed

If you hit 60+, your website is more polished than 90% of what freelancers deliver to clients. That's the AI Engineer Academy standard.